

LEARNERS BOOK ONE

Chapter 4 - BASIC SKILLS IN NETBALL.

What is netball game in PE, play area and netball equipment, detailed basic skills of netball, safety precautions in netball, rules of netball, netball hand signals.

1. Netball Game in PE

Netball is a fast-paced, team-based sport often played in physical education (PE) classes, focusing on hand-eye coordination, teamwork, and fitness. Each team has seven players, and the game objective is to score more points than the opposing team by shooting the ball through a hoop. Unlike basketball, netball players cannot dribble and must pass the ball to advance it across the court.

2. Play Area and Netball Equipment

- **Play Area:**
 - A standard netball court is rectangular and measures 30.5 meters in length and 15.25 meters in width.
 - The court is divided into thirds (center third and two goal thirds) and has a goal circle at each end, which is a semicircle with a 4.9-meter radius.
 - There is a center circle (0.9 meters in diameter) used for starting the game and after each goal.
 - The positions restrict players to certain areas on the court, promoting strategic passing and teamwork.
- **Netball Equipment:**
 - **Netball Posts:** Two 3.05-meter (10-foot) goalposts with no backboard and a ring diameter of 38 cm.
 - **Netball Ball:** Slightly smaller and lighter than a basketball, typically weighing between 400–450 grams, and a circumference of about 69–71 cm.
 - **Uniforms:** Bibs for each position (e.g., GS for Goal Shooter, WA for Wing Attack, WD wing defender, C for center, GD goal defender) are worn for easy identification.

3. Basic Skills of Netball

- **Passing:**
 - **Chest Pass:** Quick, direct pass from the chest to a teammate.
 - **Bounce Pass:** Used when a defender is blocking; the ball bounces on the ground before reaching the receiver.
 - **Overhead Pass:** Passes over the heads of defenders, useful for long-distance passes.
 - **Shoulder Pass:** A powerful, one-handed pass to cover long distances.

- **Shooting:**
 - Players (mainly Goal Shooter and Goal Attack) shoot with a high arc to increase accuracy into the hoop, focusing on wrist flick and follow-through.
- **Footwork:**
 - Players practice balanced landings (on one foot) and pivots to avoid traveling and maintain control of the ball.
 - Learning how to step effectively without losing ball possession is crucial, as "stepping" can lead to turnovers.
- **Defense:**
 - **Marking:** Staying within three feet of an opponent to block or intercept passes.
 - **Intercepting:** Timing jumps or sidesteps to disrupt a pass.
 - **Rebounding:** Retrieving the ball after a missed shot to regain possession.
- **Dodging and Movement:**
 - Players use quick changes in direction to evade defenders and create space for passes or shots.

4. Safety Precautions in Netball

- **Proper Warm-up:** Warming up and stretching reduce muscle strains and injuries.
- **Correct Footwear:** Players should wear supportive sports shoes with good traction to avoid slipping.
- **Hydration:** Players should stay hydrated, especially in outdoor games.
- **No Jewelry:** Jewelry can cause injuries, so players should remove all jewelry before playing.
- **Nail Safety:** Nails should be trimmed to avoid scratching or hurting other players.
- **Spacing and Control:** Players must keep safe distances to avoid collisions and play under control to minimize the risk of injury.

5. Basic Rules of Netball

- **Team Composition:** Seven players per team, each assigned a position with a specific area they can operate in.
- **Game Duration:** Typically consists of four 15-minute quarters, with breaks in between.
- **Scoring:** Only Goal Shooter (GS) and Goal Attack (GA) can score goals within the goal circle.
- **Three-Second Rule:** A player must pass the ball within three seconds.
- **Footwork Rule:** Players can pivot on one foot but must not move both feet; this is called "stepping."
- **Contact Rule:** Physical contact is not allowed; players must not push or hold an opponent.
- **Obstruction Rule:** Defenders must stand three feet away from the ball holder to avoid blocking or obstructing them directly.
- **Throw-In:** When the ball goes out of bounds, the opposing team takes a throw-in.

6. Netball Hand Signals

- **Goal Scored:** The umpire points upward.
- **Contact:** The umpire raises their hand with one arm pointing horizontally toward the infringing player.
- **Stepping:** The umpire mimics a stepping motion with their hands.
- **Obstruction:** The umpire shows a "3" with their fingers, indicating the three-foot distance.
- **Held Ball:** The umpire holds up three fingers to signify the three-second rule.
- **Throw-In Direction:** The umpire points in the direction of the team awarded the throw-in.

Understanding these basics, rules, skills, and safety measures can help beginners develop skills in PE classes and play netball safely and effectively.

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